

OVERVIEW

Have you ever struggled to get students to talk productively to one another during a class discussion? Does it feel like pulling teeth to get a conversation rolling? You are not alone! In this conversation, you'll explore how to support meaningful student-to-student discussions for learning in a math classroom.

SPARK MEDIA & FOCUS LESSON

Animated Video

Two teachers take different approaches to classroom discussions, in the lesson [Big Foot Conspiracy](#).

PEDAGOGICAL THEME

Fostering Student Discourse

USING THE CONVO GUIDE FOR A GREAT ROUNDTABLE DISCUSSION

- This conversation is designed for a group of 2-5 educators over 30-60 minutes.
- The Convo Guide serves as an agenda for a roundtable conversation where everyone is there both to learn and to share their expertise.
- Each participant should have their own copy of the Convo Guide and access to the Spark Media.
- Pace yourselves to get through the entire agenda in the time you have.
- Questions aren't intended to have a single right answer; instead, they're designed to spark rich discussions.
- At the end, everyone will commit to trying "one small thing" the very next day. Consider how you might follow up with one another!

OBSERVE

5-15 MIN

- To start, take a look at the Spark Media.
- What patterns do you notice in the different conversation scenarios? What would a natural conversation among peers look and sound like?
- How do you think it would feel to be a student in these conversations?

DISCUSS

10-15 MIN

- What do the patterns and your other observations suggest to you about how the students view their role and the role of their teacher? What do the roles convey about who owns the authority/knowledge/learning?
- What skills and mindsets do students (or humans, generally) need in order to engage in meaningful discourse with one another?

RELATE

10-15 MIN

- What does a typical class discussion look like with your students? What do you want it to look like?
- In both the short and long term, how can you support students in developing the skills and mindsets necessary for your ideal classroom discussions?

...AND COMMIT!

5-10 MIN

- What is one small thing you can do tomorrow in support of those shifts?